OSHA Scaffold Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1926.451)

For the competent person's check before each shift and after anything that may have affected the scaffold's structure.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.451

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item fails, keep employees off the affected part until it is repaired, replaced or braced, or until the scaffold is removed from service.
3. The scaffold manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.451: General requirements (Part 1926 Subpart L: Scaffolds) Aerial lifts are covered by 29 CFR 1926.453, not this section Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-451-scaffolds

SECTION A | Foundation, bracing and capacity

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Design Ref. 1926.451(a)(6)	Scaffold built and loaded as the qualified person's design specifies	☐	☐	☐	
2	Load on platforms Ref. 1926.451(f)(1)	Workers and materials within the maximum intended load or rated capacity, whichever is less	☐	☐	☐	
3	Base plates and mud sills Ref. 1926.451(c)(2)	Every pole, leg, post, frame and upright bears on base plates and mud sills or other adequate firm foundation	☐	☐	☐	
4	Footings Ref. 1926.451(c)(2)(i)	Level, sound and rigid, with no settling or displacement under the loaded scaffold	☐	☐	☐	
5	Unstable supports Ref. 1926.451(c)(2)(ii)	No unstable objects supporting the scaffold or platform units	☐	☐	☐	
6	Plumb and bracing Ref. 1926.451(c)(3)	Uprights plumb, bracing in place, no swaying or displacement	☐	☐	☐	
7	Ties above 4:1 Ref. 1926.451(c)(1)	Scaffold taller than 4 times its base width is guyed, tied or braced	☐	☐	☐	
8	Tie spacing Ref. 1926.451(c)(1)(ii)	Vertical tie positions follow the manufacturer's recommendations, or start at the 4:1 height and repeat every 20 ft or less (3 ft wide or less) or 26 ft or less (wider). In all cases: ties at each end, no more than 30 ft apart horizontally, and the top tie no further than the 4:1 height from the top	☐	☐	☐	
9	Power line clearance Ref. 1926.451(f)(6)	At least 10 ft from insulated lines of 300 V to 50 kV and uninsulated lines under 50 kV, at least 3 ft from insulated lines under 300 V, and more for lines over 50 kV	☐	☐	☐	
10	Damaged components Ref. 1926.451(f)(4)	No damaged or weakened part in use unless repaired, replaced or braced to the strength required by (a)	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION B | Platforms

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Full planking Ref. 1926.451(b)(1)	Each working level fully planked or decked between front uprights and guardrail supports	☐	☐	☐	
12	Gaps Ref. 1926.451(b)(1)(i)	No more than 1 in between units and between platform and uprights (where a wider space has been justified, no more than 9 1/2 in)	☐	☐	☐	
13	Width Ref. 1926.451(b)(2)	At least 18 in wide, or the width (b)(2)(i) or (b)(2)(ii) allows	☐	☐	☐	
14	Distance from work face Ref. 1926.451(b)(3)	Front edge within 14 in of the work face, or guardrails or fall arrest in use along it. Outrigger scaffolds: no more than 3 in from the face. Plastering and lathing: no more than 18 in	☐	☐	☐	
15	End bearing Ref. 1926.451(b)(4)	Each end at least 6 in past the support centerline, or cleated or hooked	☐	☐	☐	
16	Overhang Ref. 1926.451(b)(5)(i)	Platforms 10 ft or shorter overhang no more than 12 in unless designed for it or guarded against access	☐	☐	☐	
17	Overlaps Ref. 1926.451(b)(7)	Overlaps only over supports, at least 12 in, or nailed or restrained	☐	☐	☐	
18	Debris Ref. 1926.451(f)(13)	No debris building up on platforms	☐	☐	☐	
19	Slippery surfaces Ref. 1926.451(f)(8)	No snow, ice or other slippery material, except while workers are removing it	☐	☐	☐	
20	Makeshift height Ref. 1926.451(f)(14)	No boxes, barrels or other makeshift devices used to gain working height	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Access

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
21	Means of access Ref. 1926.451(e)(1)	Ladder, stair tower, ramp, walkway, integral access or direct access wherever the platform is over 2 ft above or below the access point	☐	☐	☐	
22	Cross braces Ref. 1926.451(e)(9)(iv)	Nobody climbing cross braces on tubular welded frame scaffolds	☐	☐	☐	
23	Ladder position Ref. 1926.451(e)(2)(i)	Portable, hook-on and attachable ladders placed so they cannot tip the scaffold	☐	☐	☐	
24	Bottom rung Ref. 1926.451(e)(2)(ii)	Hook-on or attachable ladder bottom rung no more than 24 in above the supporting level	☐	☐	☐	
25	Rest platforms Ref. 1926.451(e)(2)(iii)	Rest platforms at 35 ft maximum vertical intervals on supported scaffolds over 35 ft high	☐	☐	☐	
26	Stair tower rails Ref. 1926.451(e)(4)(i)	Toprail and midrail on each side of each scaffold stairway	☐	☐	☐	
27	Ramps and walkways Ref. 1926.451(e)(5)(i)	Guardrails on ramps and walkways 6 ft or more above lower levels	☐	☐	☐	
28	Direct access Ref. 1926.451(e)(8)	Scaffold no more than 14 in horizontally and 24 in vertically from the other surface	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Fall and falling object protection

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
29	Fall protection Ref. 1926.451(g)(1)	Every employee over 10 ft up is protected by the system (g)(1)(i) to (g)(1)(vii) requires for this scaffold type	☐	☐	☐	
30	Guardrail coverage Ref. 1926.451(g)(4)(i)	Guardrails on all open sides and ends before anyone other than erection or dismantling crews uses the scaffold	☐	☐	☐	
31	Toprail height Ref. 1926.451(g)(4)(ii)	38 to 45 in above the platform (36 to 45 in on supported scaffolds made and placed in service before January 1, 2000, and on suspended scaffolds needing both guardrail and fall arrest)	☐	☐	☐	
32	Midrails Ref. 1926.451(g)(4)(iv)	Midrail approximately midway between top edge and platform	☐	☐	☐	
33	No banding Ref. 1926.451(g)(4)(xiii)	No steel or plastic banding used as toprail or midrail	☐	☐	☐	
34	Fall arrest attachment Ref. 1926.451(g)(3)	Lanyard attached to a vertical lifeline, horizontal lifeline or scaffold structural member	☐	☐	☐	
35	Toeboards Ref. 1926.451(h)(4)(ii)	At least three and one-half in high at the outermost edge, no more than 1/4 in gap above the surface, openings no larger than 1 in	☐	☐	☐	
36	Area below Ref. 1926.451(h)(2)(i)	Area below barricaded with no entry, or another (h)(2) measure in place where objects could strike employees below	☐	☐	☐	
37	Hardhats and overhead protection Ref. 1926.451(h)(1)	Hardhats worn on the scaffold, plus toeboards, screens, guardrails, nets, catch platforms or canopies against small falling objects	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Inspection, supervision and conditions

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
38	Pre-shift inspection Ref. 1926.451(f)(3)	Competent person checked for visible defects before this shift and after any event that may have affected the structure	☐	☐	☐	
39	Erection crew Ref. 1926.451(f)(7)	Erecting, moving, dismantling or altering supervised by a competent person and done by trained, experienced employees that person selected	☐	☐	☐	
40	Wind and storms Ref. 1926.451(f)(12)	No work in storms or high winds unless a competent person found it safe and workers have fall arrest or wind screens, with the scaffold secured for wind forces	☐	☐	☐	
41	Swinging loads Ref. 1926.451(f)(9)	Tag lines or equivalent control on loads hoisted onto or near the scaffold	☐	☐	☐	
42	Suspension ropes Ref. 1926.451(d)(10)	Ropes inspected by a competent person this workshift, with none showing a replacement condition in (d)(10)(i) to (d)(10)(vi)	☐	☐	☐	
43	Counterweight material Ref. 1926.451(d)(3)(ii)	Counterweights of non-flowable material, with no sand, gravel or similar easily dislocated material	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION E | Inspection, supervision and conditions

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
44	Counterweight type Ref. 1926.451(d)(3)(iii)	Only items specifically designed as counterweights, with no masonry units, rolls of roofing felt or other construction materials	☐	☐	☐	
45	Counterweight securing Ref. 1926.451(d)(3)(iv)	Counterweights secured to the outrigger beams by mechanical means	☐	☐	☐	
46	Tiebacks Ref. 1926.451(d)(3)(ix)	Tiebacks secured to structurally sound anchorage, not standpipes, vents, piping or electrical conduit	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME

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